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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

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21 must-know stories, 30 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 649 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Suspended MPs, rushed Bills, missing data: How Parliament is losing its voice

It is in the news amid growing debates on the quality of legislative proceedings and executive dominance. The report highlights the declining effectiveness of Parliament due to suspended MPs, rushed legislation, and lack of data.

When: 2026-10-24 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Parliament of India

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the health of Indian democracy and legislative accountability.; Important for GS2 syllabus under Parliament and structure of government.*

Static — Parliament of India consists of the President and two Houses: the Rajya Sabha and the Lok Sabha. Article 79 of the Constitution provides for the establishment of Parliament. Parliamentary committees examine Bills in detail, though referring bills to them has seen a decline.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution

The Indian Express: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Dismisses Appeals on Delay in Arbitration Proceedings — Upholds Limitation Periods. The court emphasized that delays beyond 120 days in filing appeals under Section 37 of the Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996 cannot be condoned.

The ruling came into the news following the Supreme Court's strict stance on upholding limitation periods for arbitration appeals. The Supreme Court dismissed appeals regarding delays in arbitration proceedings, ruling that delays beyond 120 days under Section 37 cannot be condoned.

When: 2026-10-24 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** Statute involved: Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996; Section in question: Section 37; Maximum permissible timeline limit emphasized: 120 days

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces the legislative intent of speedy dispute resolution in commercial matters.; Prevents prolonged litigation and uncertainty in enforcing arbitral awards.*

Static — The Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996 is based on the UNCITRAL Model Law on International Commercial Arbitration to provide a fair and efficient dispute resolution process. Section 37 of the Act provides for appeals against orders of the arbitral tribunal or court to a higher court. Limitation periods ensure that legal remedies are pursued within a reasonable timeframe, preventing stale claims and judicial backlog.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

Lawtext: read the source · also reported by thekashmirimages.com

GS2 MAKE NOTES

SC rolls back blanket rule on death-penalty reports

The Supreme Court withdrew its direction requiring trial and high courts to call for mitigation and aggravation reports in every death-eligible case. A three-judge bench accepted a clarification plea by NALSA, noting the blanket rule was unworkable when capital punishment is not contemplated. NALSA argued that trial courts lack the resources and facilities to undertake extensive mitigation exercises for every single death-eligible offence. The bench deleted a key paragraph from its April 27, 2026 order and ordered a corrigendum to be circulated to all concerned authorities. Other directives from the April order, including high court duties at the death reference stage and dedicated legal teams, remain in place. The original April directive aimed to prevent delays caused by collecting background material only after matters reached the Supreme Court. The Supreme Court had previously highlighted recurring failures in collecting material on mitigating circumstances and inadequate legal representation in capital cases. The latest order was passed during proceedings in a murder case originating from Bihar.

When: 2026-10-24 · **Where:** Bihar · **Who:** Supreme Court, NALSA, Justices Vikram Nath, Sandeep Mehta, Aparesh Kumar Singh · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court bench consisted of justices Vikram Nath, Sandeep Mehta, and Aparesh Kumar Singh.; The original directive being modified

was issued on April 27, 2026.; Bachan Singh Vs State of Punjab judgment was delivered in 1980.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Prevents administrative overreach and procedural gridlock in trial courts burdened with resource constraints.; Retains essential safeguards like high court mitigation checks, dedicated legal teams, and psychological evaluations in capital cases.*

Static — In Bachan Singh v. State of Punjab (1980), the Supreme Court upheld the death penalty's constitutional validity but restricted it to the rarest of rare cases. Bachan Singh mandated that courts must consider both crime and offender circumstances, giving full weight to mitigating factors before sentencing. Mitigating factors include the accused's age, mental condition, social and family background, and the possibility of reform and rehabilitation.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Report/Index

Hindustan Times: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

False Election Affidavit: Supreme Court Says Voters Can File Private Complaint Against Candidates Under...

The ruling came in response to legal questions surrounding the accountability of electoral candidates who conceal or falsify mandatory disclosures. The Supreme Court held that ordinary voters have the legal right to file private criminal complaints against candidates who submit false affidavits during elections.

When: 2026-10-24 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India, Voters, Candidates · **Prelims:** Supreme Court allowed voters to file private complaints against false election affidavits.; The ruling impacts how candidates' disclosures are scrutinized legally.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Empowers citizens to directly challenge electoral malpractice and corruption without relying solely on state machinery.; Enhances transparency and accountability of political candidates during elections.*

Static — The Supreme Court of India is the highest judicial forum and final court of appeal under the Constitution, established under Article 124. Article 324 of the Constitution vests the superintendence, direction, and control of elections in the Election Commission of India. Filing false affidavits or concealing information regarding criminal background, assets, and liabilities constitutes an offence under relevant laws like the Representation of the People Act, 1951.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

LawBeat: read the source · *also reported by Civilsdaily*

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

National Anti-Doping (Amendment) Act, 2025: Strengthening India’s Anti-Doping Framework by Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.

The legislative update was reported by the IMPRI Impact and Policy Research Institute to strengthen the national anti-doping framework. The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports introduced the National Anti-Doping (Amendment) Act, 2025 to further strengthen India's anti-doping framework.

When: 2025 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports · **Prelims:** The Act was introduced by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.; It is titled the National Anti-Doping (Amendment) Act, 2025.; The report was published by IMPRI Impact and Policy Research Institute.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Ensures greater compliance with international anti-doping standards set by WADA.; Enhances the operational efficiency and investigative powers of domestic anti-doping institutions.*

Static — The National Anti Doping Agency NADA is the national organization responsible for promoting, coordinating, and monitoring the doping control program in sports in India. NADA operates as a registered society under the Societies Registration Act and works alongside the National Doping Test Laboratory NDTL. The World Anti Doping Agency WADA sets the global standards and code for anti doping policies across international sports.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Polity & Constitution, Society · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

IMPRI Impact and Policy Research Institute: read the source · *also reported by Prothom Alo English*

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Viksit Bharat- G RAM G

The Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission Gramin recorded active workers numbering 10.88 crore in 2026-27 with assets created totalling 2.83 lakh. Person-days generated exceeded 31.69 crore while women's participation stood at 61.65 per cent under the scheme. Employment was provided on demand to over 2.81 crore workers from about 2.23 crore rural households, with 97.17 lakh workers currently under execution. Through Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans, Gram Panchayats identify local needs, map existing assets, and prioritise development works. Nearly 2.31 lakh Gram Panchayats are executing works nationwide, recording 3.76 crore direct benefit transfer transactions in 2026-27. Wage rates range from Rs 300 to Rs 450 per day and 15.17 crore Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Cards have been issued. The VB-G RAM G Act 2025 provides a statutory guarantee of 125 days of wage employment every financial year for rural households.

When: 2026-10-24 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Gram Panchayats, Gram Sabhas, Rural Households · **Prelims:** Active workers stood at 10.88 crore in 2026-27.; Statutory guarantee provides 125 days of wage employment every financial year.; Wage rates range from Rs 300 to Rs 450 per day.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Guarantees 125 days of wage employment, expanding livelihood security for rural households.; Promotes bottom-up, participatory rural planning through Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans.*

Static — The Act provides a statutory guarantee of 125 days of wage employment every financial year to every rural household whose adult members volunteer for unskilled manual work. It focuses on four thematic areas: water security, core rural infrastructure, livelihood-related infrastructure, and mitigation of extreme weather events. The framework institutionalises a whole-of-government approach through convergence-driven and saturation-oriented planning using Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

PIB: read the source · *free copy on ianslive.in*

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

India Launches Rural Employment and Livelihood Guarantee Mission

The launch of the new mission by OpenGov Asia puts rural employment generation in focus. India has officially launched the Rural Employment and Livelihood Guarantee Mission to enhance income and job security in rural areas.

When: 2026-10-24 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Government of India · **Prelims:** Mission Name: Rural Employment and Livelihood Guarantee Mission; Launch Country: India; Focus Sector: Rural employment and livelihoods

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides a safety net for vulnerable rural households by assuring employment opportunities.; Aids in building resilient rural infrastructure and community assets.*

Static — Rural employment guarantee schemes in India trace their origin to statutory legal frameworks ensuring right to work. The Ministry of Rural Development is the nodal agency responsible for planning, implementation, and monitoring of rural livelihood programmes. Gram panchayats play a crucial role at the grassroot level in planning, approving, and executing rural development works.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Economy · Prelims angle: Scheme

OpenGov Asia: read the source

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

PLFS Revamp – Capturing India's Gig Economy and the Invisible Burden of Unpaid Work

The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation is revamping the Periodic Labour Force Survey to improve the measurement of emerging forms of employment and unpaid work. The revised design will be implemented from January 2027 to better capture digital platform workers, unpaid household and caregiving work, volunteer activities, and unpaid trainee work. Conventional employment statistics often understate the contribution of workers in informal, platform-based, and non-market activities, particularly women's unpaid work. A separate Second Stage Stratum will be created for households containing digital platform workers to improve their representation in the sample. An additional yes/no screening question will identify whether any household member worked through a digital platform like Ola, Uber, Zomato, Amazon, or Urban Company during the preceding 365 days. Identified platform workers will be asked about goods provided, multiple platforms, entry reasons, and major challenges like long hours and inadequate social security. The survey will collect information on own-use production, unpaid household and caregiving activities, volunteer work, and unpaid trainee work for persons aged 15 and above.

When: January 2027 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation · **Prelims:** The revamped PLFS design will be implemented from January 2027.; Platform workers screening will cover platforms including Ola, Uber, Zomato, Amazon, and Urban Company.; Questions on unpaid household and caregiving activities will be asked to persons aged 15 years and above.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Improves statistical visibility and policy design for the growing gig and platform economy.; Captures the invisible burden of unpaid care work and its impact on female labour force participation.*

Static — The Periodic Labour Force Survey was launched in 2017 by the National Statistical Office under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation. PLFS was designed to measure dynamic changes in labour market conditions on a quarterly basis for urban areas and annually for both rural and urban areas. The survey estimates key employment and unemployment indicators such as the Worker Population Ratio, Labour Force Participation Rate, and Unemployment Rate.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Report/Index

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI Hikes Repo Rate by 25 bps to 5.50%; Switches Stance to Calibrated Tightening

The Reserve Bank of India increased the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50% during its October Monetary Policy Committee meeting. The central bank shifted its policy stance from neutral to 'calibrated tightening' due to growing concerns over widening inflationary pressures. RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra highlighted that inflation is spreading across different sectors and projected it to approach 6% during the October-December quarter. SBI Research predicts further monetary tightening equivalent to 50 basis points in December, through a direct rate hike or liquidity adjustments. Economists like Dr Soumya Kanti Ghosh note that rising inflation and persistent rupee weakness require close monitoring by the monetary authority. Committee members cited strong economic growth alongside inflation risks as key reasons for adopting a hawkish policy stance. Despite global challenges and elevated crude oil prices, the Indian rupee appreciated about 1.5% against the US dollar due to foreign exchange regulations and IPO inflows.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** Mumbai · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India, Sanjay Malhotra, Dr Soumya Kanti Ghosh, Radhika Rao · **Prelims:** The repo rate was increased by 25 basis points to 5.50%.; The RBI policy stance was changed to 'calibrated tightening'.; Inflation is projected to approach 6 per cent during the October-December quarter.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Signals a decisive monetary policy shift towards tighter financial conditions to curb expanding inflationary pressures.; Impacts borrowing costs for commercial banks and retail consumers, influencing overall credit growth and economic activity.*

Static — The Monetary Policy Committee is a statutory body constituted under Section 45ZB of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934 to determine the policy rate required to achieve the inflation target. The MPC comprises six members: the RBI Governor as chairperson, three external members appointed by the central government, and two officials nominated by the RBI board. The repo rate is the interest rate at which the central bank lends money to commercial banks in the event of any shortfall of funds.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

freepressjournal.in: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Central Bank of India reports Rs. 13.96 crore loss in 187 unauthorised transactions

Central Bank of India reported that Rs 13.97 crore was siphoned from its settlement account with the RBI. The siphoning occurred through 187 unauthorised transfers executed between October 15 and 17. The bank alleges that unknown persons breached the central SFMS server of Iftas using the core banking system's SFMS server. The stolen funds were diverted into 36 different bank accounts as per the FIR registered at the Nodal Cyber Police Station in Mumbai. A total of 6 transfers occurred on October 15, 88 on October 16, and 93 on October 17. The bank's internal team failed to find any of these 187 transactions in branches, mobile banking, internet banking, or core systems. Partial traces of 10 accounts appeared in SFMS database logs, but transaction IDs were missing from bank records. The bank immediately notified the RBI, Iftas, Daksh portal, NCIIPC, and CERT-In regarding the cyber incident.

When: October 15-17, 2026 · **Where:** Mumbai · **Who:** Central Bank of India, Iftas, Nodal Cyber Police Station Mumbai, RBI · **Prelims:** Amount siphoned: Rs 13.97 crore across 187 unauthorised transactions.; Dates of transactions: Between October 15 and 17 (6 on Oct 15, 88 on Oct 16, 93 on Oct 17).; Number of beneficiary bank accounts: 36 accounts.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights vulnerabilities in critical financial market infrastructure and central payment routing servers.; Poses significant cyber security challenges for public sector banks and regulatory bodies managing payment settlements.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is India's central banking institution, established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. Indian Financial Technology and Allied Services (Iftas) is a wholly-owned subsidiary of the RBI that provides critical financial technology services to the Indian banking sector. Structured Financial Messaging System (SFMS) is a secure messaging standard used by banks for transmitting financial messages across RTGS and NEFT platforms.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Data/Stats

Hindustan Times: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

IMF-World Bank Annual Meetings

Burgan Bank participated in the 2026 Annual Meetings of the International Monetary Fund and the World Bank Group in Bangkok, Thailand, from October 12 to 18. The delegation was led by Chairman Sheikh Abdullah Nasser Sabah Al-Ahmad Al-Sabah to engage with the international financial community and support Kuwait's financial ambitions. The core agenda in Bangkok focused on financial resilience, global growth outlook, investment, and the changing role of technology in banking. Key delegation members included Vice Chairman Faisal M Sarkhou and other senior executives spanning institutional banking, treasury, and investment markets. The bank attended the annual reception hosted by the Kuwait Banking Association alongside Finance Minister Dr Yaqoub Yousef Al-Refai and Central Bank Governor Basel Ahmed Al-Haroon. Burgan Bank also participated in the GCC–Asia Economic Forum on October 14, examining core banking, cross-border investment, and digital infrastructure. The bank highlighted that the next phase of GCC–Asia cooperation depends on strong balance-sheet partnerships and secure financial infrastructure to connect capital. The Group is advancing the proposed transition of United Gulf Bank to Burgan Bank Bahrain to build a more connected regional banking platform.

When: October 12 to 18, 2026 · **Where:** Bangkok, Thailand · **Who:** Sheikh Abdullah Nasser Sabah Al-Ahmad Al-Sabah, Burgan Bank delegation, Dr Yaqoub Yousef Al-Refai, Basel Ahmed Al-Haroon · **Prelims:** The 2026 IMF-World Bank Annual Meetings were held in Bangkok, Thailand.; The meetings took place from October 12 to 18, 2026.; The GCC–Asia Economic Forum was jointly organized by the Kuwait Banking Association and the Asian Bankers Association.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the growing financial and economic linkages between the GCC region and Asian markets.; Showcases how regional commercial banks engage with global monetary policies and international capital flows.*

Static — The International Monetary Fund and the World Bank Group were established at the 1944 Bretton Woods Conference in New Hampshire, United States. The IMF focuses on ensuring the stability of the international monetary system, while the World Bank focuses on long-term economic development and poverty reduction. The Annual Meetings of the IMF and World Bank bring together central bankers, ministers of finance and development, private sector executives, and academics.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, International Relations

msn.com: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

IMF raises India’s FY27 growth forecast to 7%, warns of converging risks

The International Monetary Fund raised India's FY27 growth forecast from 6.4 percent to 7 percent, driven by better-than-expected economic performance. The primary trigger for caution is an energy crisis caused by disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz that shows no signs of easing. The core risk highlighted by the IMF is the potential confluence of multiple shocks coming together to weigh on regional and Indian growth. Specific risks include a weakening rupee, rising borrowing costs, uncertainty surrounding the artificial intelligence boom, and the threat of El Nino. The IMF Asia chief warned that prolonged energy shocks could fuel domestic inflation, weaken external balances, and erode household purchasing power. Central banks are advised to remain agile and keep price stability as their primary objective while responding proactively to price pressures. Fiscal buffers across the region are thinning due to back-to-back shocks, leaving limited room to absorb higher energy import costs. The IMF recommended long-term strategies such as diversifying energy sources, reducing fossil fuel dependence, and carrying out domestic land and labour reforms.

When: 2026-10-24 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Krishna Srinivasan, International Monetary Fund · **Prelims:** IMF raised India's FY27 growth forecast to 7 percent from 6.4 percent.; Medium-term growth for India is projected by the IMF at around 6.9 percent.; Global trade restrictions tripled between the years 2019 and 2025.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's resilient economic growth amidst a complex and volatile global macroeconomic environment.; Serves as an important policy warning regarding the dangers of converging energy shocks, inflation, and fiscal deficit pressures.*

Static — The International Monetary Fund is an international organization of 190 countries, working to foster global monetary cooperation and secure financial stability. The IMF was established in December 1945 at the Bretton Woods Conference, and is headquartered in Washington, D.C. India is a founding member of the IMF and holds an important quota share that determines its voting power and financial contribution.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, International Relations

indiatoday.in: read the source

Agriculture & Allied

GS3 MAKE NOTES

11 Crore Farmer IDs Created Five Months Ahead of Schedule, Marking Major Milestone in Digital Agriculture: Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan

The Centre has successfully created 11 crore unique 11-digit Farmer IDs, also known as Kisan Pehchaan Patra, under the AgriStack framework. This milestone was achieved on the night of October 23, five months ahead of the original March 31, 2027 deadline set by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The initiative is a core part of the Digital Agriculture Mission implemented by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare. Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan announced the achievement through a video message, calling it a historic day for Indian agriculture. The Farmer ID acts as a unique digital identity designed to ensure transparent, efficient, and timely delivery of government scheme benefits. It eliminates the need for farmers to repeatedly submit piles of paperwork or endless documentation for verification. The ID serves as the single document required for farmers to access bank loans, Kisan Credit Cards, crop insurance, and disaster relief. The rapid rollout was achieved through close coordination between Central government officials, state governments, Union Territories, and district administrations.

When: October 23 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan, Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare · **Prelims:** 11 crore unique 11-digit Farmer IDs were created under AgriStack.; The initiative is implemented under the Digital Agriculture Mission.; The original target deadline was March 31, 2027.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces administrative friction and document duplication for farmers accessing credit and government support.; Ensures leakage-proof and transparent delivery of welfare benefits, crop insurance, and disaster relief.*

Static — AgriStack is a digital public infrastructure for agriculture being built by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare to streamline services for farmers. The Digital Agriculture Mission leverages modern technologies like artificial intelligence, remote sensing, and GIS to improve planning, efficiency, and policy implementation in the farm sector. Unique Farmer IDs are digitally linked with land records, crop sown data, and demographic details to create a verified registry of farmers across India.

Syllabus: GS3: Agriculture & Allied, Governance & Policy, Disaster Management · Prelims angle: Data/Stats, Scheme

PIB: read the source · free copy on ptinews.com · also reported by Economic Times, All India Radio (NewsOnAir)

Infrastructure & Energy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

500 GW by 2030: Experts explain why India needs to power up battery storage capacity and grid infra to meet the target

Experts at an industry event stated that India must expand battery storage and grid infrastructure alongside renewable energy capacity. The push aims to ensure reliable power supply as India advances toward its goal of 500 GW of non-fossil fuel capacity by 2030. India has already crossed 300 GW of installed non-fossil fuel capacity, but integrating more renewables requires investment in storage, manufacturing, and research. Jai Asundi of CSTEP noted that integrating more renewable power into the grid requires heavy investment in energy storage and domestic manufacturing. Yogesh Mudras of Informa Markets highlighted that India's renewable market is projected to reach 486 GW by 2030, with battery storage crossing $8.5 billion by 2031. Anandi Iyer of the Fraunhofer Office suggested India and Germany collaborate in battery research, power electronics, and advanced engineering. Australian High Commissioner Philip Green noted Australia produces over half the world's lithium and can partner with India on critical minerals and supply chains. Scotland First Minister John Swinney said Scottish innovation can complement India's manufacturing scale to support the clean energy transition.

When: 2026-10-24 · **Where:** Greater Noida · **Who:** Jai Asundi, Yogesh Mudras, Anandi Iyer, Philip Green, John Swinney, Manu Srivastav · **Prelims:** India has crossed 300 GW of installed non-fossil fuel capacity.; Australia produces more than half of the world's lithium.; India's battery storage sector is expected to cross $8.5 billion by 2031.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the operational bottlenecks and infrastructure requirements of India's ambitious non-fossil energy transition.; Stresses the importance of international collaborations, such as with Australia and Germany, for critical minerals and research.*

Static — India has set an ambitious target of achieving 500 GW of non-fossil fuel electricity capacity by the year 2030. Battery energy storage systems (BESS) are critical for storing intermittent renewable energy like solar and wind power to ensure grid stability. India heavily relies on imports for critical minerals like lithium, cobalt, and nickel, which are essential for manufacturing electric vehicle and grid-scale batteries.

Syllabus: GS3: Infrastructure & Energy

Mint: read the source · free copy on timesofindia.indiatimes.com

Environment & Ecology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Snow Leopard Population Assessment in India (SPAI) and Snow Leopard

India has recorded an estimated 718 snow leopards across the Indian Himalayas according to the first Snow Leopard Population Assessment in India. The assessment was conducted as the country's first-ever scientific exercise taking around 4 years to complete. The Wildlife Institute of India served as the National Coordinator for coordinating this comprehensive population assessment exercise. Ladakh recorded the highest number of snow leopards with 477 individuals in the wild. Uttarakhand recorded 124 snow leopards, followed by Himachal Pradesh with 51, and Arunachal Pradesh with 36. Sikkim recorded 21 snow leopards while Jammu and Kashmir accounted for 9 individuals. India currently holds around 10 to 15 percent of the total global population of snow leopards. The findings provide crucial data for shaping future conservation strategies for high-altitude Himalayan ecosystems.

When: 2026-10-24 · **Where:** Indian Himalayas, Ladakh, Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Arunachal Pradesh, Sikkim, Jammu and Kashmir · **Who:** Wildlife Institute of India · **Prelims:** Estimated total snow leopard population in India is 718.; Ladakh has the highest number of snow leopards at 477.; Wildlife Institute of India acted as the National Coordinator for the SPAI exercise.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides reliable baseline data for future wildlife management and high-altitude conservation policies in India.; Helps India fulfill its international commitments under the Global Snow Leopard and Ecosystem Protection Programme.*

Static — The snow leopard is a large cat species belonging to the genus Panthera and family Felidae, native to Central and South Asian mountain ranges. They act as top predators in mountain ecosystems and possess physical adaptations like broad paws with fur and long balancing tails. Project Snow Leopard was launched by the Government of India in 2009 to promote inclusive conservation of the species and its habitat.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Society · Prelims angle: Species

ForumIAS: read the source · also reported by All India Radio (NewsOnAir), Insights on India

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Rewilding the Great Indian Bustard

The conservation programme entered a new phase in October 2026 with the actual release of captive-bred birds into their natural habitat. Four male Great Indian Bustards were released into the wild at Desert National Park in Rajasthan, marking the start of a rewilding phase. A Moment at Sam Sand Dunes After nearly a decade of conservation breeding, the Great Indian Bustard (GIB) conservation programme has entered a new phase. In October 2026 , four male GIBs were released into the wild at Desert National Park near Sam village in Jaisalmer, Rajasthan. These birds are among 10 GIBs earmarked for release from conservation-breeding facilities at Sam and Ramdevra . Historically distributed across the western half of India, the GIB has suffered a severe decline. The Wildlife Institute of India’s 2016–17 annual progress report recorded a 75% decline in the population over the preceding 30 years. Habitat loss and human-induced pressures contributed to this decline, whil

When: October 2026 · **Where:** Desert National Park, Sam village, Jaisalmer, Rajasthan · **Who:** Wildlife Institute of India · **Prelims:** Four male GIBs were released in October 2026.; Release site is Desert National Park near Sam village in Jaisalmer, Rajasthan.; Breeding facilities are situated at Sam and Ramdevra.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Marks a critical shift from captive breeding to active rewilding for a critically endangered endemic species.; Provides vital empirical lessons to refine future wildlife release protocols and grassland conservation strategies in India.*

Static — The Great Indian Bustard is listed as Critically Endangered on the IUCN Red List and receives high protection under Wildlife Protection Act schedules. The Wildlife Institute of India is an autonomous institution under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, established in 1982. Desert National Park in Rajasthan is one of the final natural strongholds and primary habitats remaining for the Great Indian Bustard.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology · Prelims angle: Species

PIB: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court orders Rajasthan to seal illegal discharge points into polluted rivers, recover fines

The Supreme Court directed the Rajasthan government to seal and dismantle all unauthorized discharge points into the Jojari-Luni-Bandi river system. The order stems from suo motu proceedings initiated after a news report highlighted severe pollution in the Jojari river, which serves a population of 2 million. The court called for a shift from a reactive to a proactive bureaucratic approach to anticipate and prevent environmental damage. State authorities were directed to initiate proceedings against landowners, occupiers, and officials responsible for unauthorized bypasses and pipelines. The Rajasthan State Pollution Control Board must assess and recover environmental compensation for the entire duration of violations from benefiting industrial units. A comprehensive technical survey of all bridges and road crossings across the three river systems must be undertaken to remove obstructions to natural flows. The court ordered strict enforcement action against illegal sand mining and asked the chief secretary to furnish details to a committee headed by former judge Sangeet Lodha. Pending proposals for Common Effluent Treatment Plants and upgrade to zero liquid discharge must be cleared through a single-window mechanism.

When: 2026-10-24 · **Where:** Rajasthan · **Who:** Supreme Court, Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta, Rajasthan State Pollution Control Board, Justice (retd) Sangeet Lodha · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court bench handling the matter comprised justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta.; The Jojari river serves a population of 2 million people in Rajasthan.; A nine-member committee assisting the court is headed by former Rajasthan High Court judge justice (retd) Sangeet Lodha.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Emphasizes the polluter pays principle by mandating compensation recovery for the entire duration of environmental violations.; Challenges bureaucratic inertia by demanding a structural shift from reactive incident management to proactive risk mitigation.*

Static — Suo motu jurisdiction allows the Supreme Court to take cognisance of matters on its own motion based on media reports or public interest letters. The Water Prevention and Control of Pollution Act empowers state pollution control boards to set standards, monitor water quality, and penalize polluters. Common Effluent Treatment Plants are collective facilities established to treat industrial wastewater from multiple small-scale industrial units before discharge.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Polity & Constitution, Geography · Prelims angle: Judgment

Hindustan Times: read the source

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Courts cannot be unmindful when precious water bodies remain unprotected: SC

The Supreme Court directed all states and authorities to undertake physical ground-truthing and demarcation of wetlands. A bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and Vipul M Pancholi noted that water bodies serve as vital sources of drinking water. The court stated that protecting water bodies falls directly within the scope of the right to life guaranteed under the Constitution. The bench emphasized that it cannot remain a mere spectator to the consequences of leaving water bodies unprotected. States and Wetland Authorities were ordered to file compliance affidavits detailing the mode and method adopted for ground-truthing. Senior counsel Shekhar Naphade requested a time of six to nine months citing the extensive physical work required. The Supreme Court granted a final outer limit of four months to complete the exercise. The court highlighted that ground-truthing and demarcation remained incomplete even nine years after the publication of the Rules. The top court issued these directions while hearing a Public Interest Litigation filed by Anand Arya, M.K. Balakrishnan, and Vanashakti.

When: 2026-10-24 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and Vipul M Pancholi, Anand Arya, M K Balakrishnan, NGO Vanashakti, Shekhar Naphade · **Prelims:** The bench consisted of Justices Aravind Kumar and Vipul M Pancholi.; The court granted a time limit of four months to complete ground-truthing.; The PIL was filed by Anand Arya, M.K. Balakrishnan, and NGO Vanashakti.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces judicial activism in environmental protection by linking water security directly to the fundamental right to life.; Holds state authorities accountable for long-standing delays in enforcing environmental rules and wetland mapping.*

Static — Wetlands in India are regulated under the Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules, which establish State Wetland Authorities for management and protection. Article 21 of the Constitution guarantees the right to life, which the judiciary has expansively interpreted to include the right to a clean and healthy environment. Public Interest Litigation (PIL) in India allows any public-spirited individual or group to approach the Supreme Court or High Courts for the enforcement of fundamental rights or public interest.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Environment & Ecology, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Place in news

The Hindu: read the source · *free copy on msn.com*

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Countdown progressing for ISRO’s crucial GSLV-F18 launch carrying navigation satellite NVS-03

ISRO is preparing to launch the GSLV-F18 mission carrying the NVS-03 navigation satellite on October 30, 2026. The launch will take place from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre. The mission is triggered by the natural aging of older spacecraft and atomic clock failures that reduced the NavIC system below required standalone strength. NavIC currently lacks the four operational satellites needed for independent positioning data, though it provides basic timing services. The core objective of NVS-03 is to restore location-tracking autonomy for India's regional GPS alternative. NVS-03 introduces civilian L1 band compatibility for mass consumer markets and heightened signal security for authorized users. The satellite weighs roughly 2,232 kilograms and will be deployed into a Geosynchronous Transfer Orbit using the GSLV Mk II rocket. A successful liftoff will bridge crucial domestic infrastructure gaps and restore full operations of India's standalone navigation.

When: October 30, 2026 · **Where:** Satish Dhawan Space Centre · **Who:** Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) · **Prelims:** Mission name: GSLV-F18; Satellite: NVS-03; Launch date: October 30, 2026

> ***Why it matters —*** *Restores India's regional navigation autonomy and reduces dependence on foreign GPS systems.; Introduces civilian L1 band compatibility for mass consumer electronics.*

Static — NavIC stands for Navigation with Indian Constellation, developed by ISRO as India's regional satellite navigation system. The system is designed to provide accurate position information service to users in India and the region extending up to 1,500 km from its boundary. GSLV (Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle) is a three-stage launch vehicle with a cryogenic upper stage capable of placing heavy payloads into GTO.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Governance & Policy, Defence · Prelims angle: Scheme

The Hindu: read the source · *free copy on sentinelassam.com* · *also reported by NewsBytes, Insights on India*

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Indigenous AIP system for Indian Navy's diesel-electric submarines achieves key milestone with inauguration of Setting to Work Phase-2 Activity

The Indian Navy's underwater capabilities received a boost with the inauguration of the Setting to Work Phase-2 activity for an indigenous Air Independent Propulsion system energy module. The system was developed indigenously by the Naval Materials Research Laboratory under the Defence Research and Development Organisation. Air Independent Propulsion systems increase the underwater endurance of conventional diesel-electric submarines by reducing their dependence on atmospheric oxygen. The technology allows conventional submarines to stay submerged for weeks at a time, typically between two to four weeks. The inauguration ceremony took place at Larsen and Toubro's AM Naik Heavy Engineering Complex in Hazira, Gujarat. Defence Secretary and DRDO Chairman Rajesh Kumar Singh attended the ceremony virtually as the chief guest. In the next phase, the module will be energised for power production and tested rigorously according to Indian Navy protocols. The tested energy module will be handed over to Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited in early 2027 for integration into a Kalvari-class submarine.

When: October 24, 2026 · **Where:** Hazira, Gujarat · **Who:** Naval Materials Research Laboratory, DRDO, Rajesh Kumar Singh, Indian Navy, Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited, Larsen and Toubro · **Prelims:** The AIP energy module was developed by Naval Materials Research Laboratory, DRDO.; The inauguration ceremony took place at L&T's AM Naik Heavy Engineering Complex in Hazira, Gujarat.; India has built six Kalvari-class submarines under Project-75 at Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Significantly enhances the stealth and underwater endurance of conventional diesel-electric submarines by enabling them to remain submerged for weeks.; Marks a major milestone in India's defence self-reliance and indigenous manufacturing capabilities under Atmanirbhar Bharat.*

Static — The Defence Research and Development Organisation is the premier agency under the Department of Defence Research and Development in the Ministry of Defence, charged with military research and development. Air Independent Propulsion technology allows non-nuclear submarines to operate without access to atmospheric oxygen, significantly lowering their acoustic and thermal signatures. Project-75 is an initiative by the Indian Navy to construct six Scorpene-design diesel-electric attack submarines at Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Science & Technology

PIB: read the source · free copy on timesofindia.indiatimes.com · also reported by Economic Times

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Theatre Commands: India Awaits Top-Level Approval

The initiative is currently in the news as discussions reach final stages for top-level political clearance. India's proposed military theater commands are awaiting final top-level political approval to restructure the armed forces into unified geographical commands.

When: 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Armed Forces, Chief of Defence Staff, Government of India

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for optimizing resource allocation and modernizing India's defense apparatus against multi-front threats.; Marks a fundamental shift in higher defense management and inter-service coordination for UPSC GS Paper 3.*

Static — The Chief of Defence Staff is the permanent Chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee and heads the Department of Military Affairs. The post of CDS was created in 2019 to provide single-point military advice to the government and promote jointness among the three services. Theatre commands integrate the logistics, intelligence, and combat assets of the Army, Navy, and Air Force under one unified commander.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence

Rediff: read the source

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

DEFENCE EXERCISE QUICK READ

Exercise "Rummy"

French and British air forces have staged a joint exercise simulating a nuclear strike codenamed exercise Rummy for the first time. The exercise was organized to enhance coordination between Western Europe's two nuclear powers. Exercise Rummy involves joint nuclear strike simulation by the air forces of France and the United Kingdom.

ForumIAS: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED QUICK READ

Kesar Mango, GI Tag, Cultivation, Production in India

Gir Kesar Mango is a prominent mango variety from Gujarat known for its saffron-coloured pulp, sweetness, and distinctive aroma. The variety is primarily cultivated in the Junagadh and adjoining Gir region, including parts of Gir Somnath district in the Saurashtra peninsula. It received its Geographical Indication (GI) registration on 24 June 2011, with the Gujarat Agro Industries Corporation Limited as the registered proprietor.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

M.P. receives investment proposals of over Rs. 15,400 crore at semiconductor summit

The Madhya Pradesh Semiconductor Summit 2026 was inaugurated in Indore on 23 October 2026. The state received semiconductor investment proposals stated at over Rs 15,400 crore to Rs 15,800 crore. The announced figures included around Rs 5,800 crore in new proposals and land-allocation letters of intent for five companies worth about Rs 10,000 crore. Chief Minister Mohan Yadav stated that the new proposals could generate over 10,000 employment opportunities.

The Hindu: source

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

G20 summit: India proposes global biofuel alliance to support energy transition; AP reports

The proposal was made during the G20 summit and reported by the Associated Press. India proposed a global biofuel alliance at the G20 summit to support the global energy transition.

The Economic Times: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED SCHEME QUICK READ

Maharashtra Launches Mission Murghas to Tackle Fodder Shortages

Maharashtra launched Mission Murghas on 24 October 2026 to tackle severe fodder shortages during drought conditions. The state faced severe distress, declaring drought in 305 talukas by 14 October and 265 talukas reaching Trigger 1 during the 2026 kharif season. The core issue is mitigating livestock feed crises during droughts through structured cultivation, storage, and distribution policies.

gktoday.in: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS SCHEME QUICK READ

EAM Jaishankar hosts African Heads of Mission, discusses rise of Africa in multipolar world

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar hosted Heads of Mission from African countries in New Delhi. Discussions focused on the India-Africa partnership, the rise of Africa in a multipolar world, and people-centric cooperation. The meeting highlighted shared histories, common aspirations, and deep South-South solidarity between India and Africa. Earlier in the month, Jaishankar also chaired a conference of India's Heads of Mission in Africa in Addis Ababa.

thehansindia.com: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT QUICK READ

Probe Agency ED Moves Top Court Against Quashing Of NewsClick Case

The Enforcement Directorate challenged the Delhi High Court order quashing a money laundering case against news portal NewsClick and editor-in-chief Prabir Purkayastha. The ED argued that the High Court quashed its Enforcement Case Information Report without examining the merits under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act. The probe agency also flagged a five-month delay in the pronouncement of the Delhi High Court judgment.

Times of India: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE SCHEME QUICK READ

Special ration for tribes; in Jhargram hamlet, Suvendu launches Centre's PVTG scheme with a dig at Mamata

The event brought the rollout of a central tribal welfare scheme in West Bengal into the headlines amid political sparring. BJP leader Suvendu Adhikari launched the Centre's scheme for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups in a Jhargram hamlet while criticizing the state government.

Telegraph India: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

Centre backs A.P.’s semiconductor push, approves rail links for nine ports

The decisions followed a high-level meeting where Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu sought central approvals for key railway and industrial projects. The central government has assured support for Andhra Pradesh's semiconductor initiatives and approved rail linkages for nine state ports, alongside a new Vande Bharat sleeper train route.

The Hindu: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY REPORT/INDEX PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Zavodovski Island

Research by the British Antarctic Survey (BAS) showed that breeding chinstrap penguins on Zavodovski Island declined by nearly 63% in 14 years. The decline is highlighted by recent scientific monitoring of the world's largest penguin colony located on the island. The core issue is the vulnerability of Antarctic ecosystems and species like the chinstrap penguin to environmental changes.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Plea before Supreme Court seeks expert committee headed by former CJI to examine ECI's functioning

A public interest litigation was filed in the Supreme Court seeking an independent expert committee to examine institutional shortcomings in the Election Commission of India. The petition follows reports that two Election Commissioners recorded written objections on 14 occasions regarding unilateral decisions by the Chief Election Commissioner. At stake is the internal governance, collegiate decision-making, and technical integrity of India's apex election management body.

Bar & Bench: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | QUICK READ

NICDC Advances Industrial Development in Bihar with Launch of Bihar Integrated Manufacturing City Gaya Limited

The Bihar Integrated Manufacturing City Gaya Limited (BIMCGL) was formally launched by Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary at Bodh Gaya. The special purpose vehicle was created to implement the Integrated Manufacturing Cluster at Gaya under the Amritsar-Kolkata Industrial Corridor. The project spans 1,670 acres in the Dobhi block of Gaya district and was approved by the Centre on August 28, 2024.

PIB: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE | QUICK READ

Three New Indian Sites Move Closer To UNESCO World Heritage Status

Recent updates from heritage bodies show these sites progressing toward final consideration for UNESCO recognition. Three new Indian sites have advanced in the evaluation process to secure the official UNESCO World Heritage status.

Travel and Leisure Asia: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Centre Announces New Opium Poppy Cultivation Policy for 2026-27, Sets Minimum Yield Benchmark of 800 Kg per Hectare [Read Notification]

The policy was brought into news due to the official release of the new notification for the 2026-27 crop year by the Central Government. The Centre has released the new Opium Poppy Cultivation Policy for the 2026-27 crop year, establishing a minimum yield benchmark of 800 kg per hectare.

StudyCafe: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Gaganyaan: 'Super excited' about upcoming G1 uncrewed test flight, says astronaut-designate Angad Pratap

The Department of Space announced the late 2026 target timeline for the G1 uncrewed experimental mission. Astronaut-designate Angad Pratap expressed excitement regarding the upcoming G1 uncrewed test flight for the Gaganyaan mission targeted for late 2026. Department of Space had announced in August that G1, the first uncrewed experimental mission to validate technologies being developed for the first time, is targeted for late 2026

The Hindu: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

19th Urban Mobility India Conference and Exhibition concludes in Bhubaneswar with participation of around 1,500 delegates and experts

The 19th Urban Mobility India Conference and Exhibition 2026 concluded in Bhubaneswar, Odisha, after a two-day event held on October 23-24, 2026. The event was organized by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs through the Institute of Urban Transport with support from the Government of Odisha. Union Minister Manohar Lal addressed the valedictory session, presented awards for excellence, and emphasized integrating urban mobility with initial urban planning.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

India, Russia aim for $100 billion trade by 2030 as Modi, Putin push cooperation

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Russian President Vladimir Putin have directed their governments to expand bilateral cooperation to reach USD 100 billion in trade by 2030. The leaders discussed strengthening bilateral relations and mutual investments targeting USD 50 billion on the sidelines of the BRICS summit in New Delhi on September 12 and 13.

Economic Times: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Nuclear power could more than triple by 2060, UN agency says

IAEA Director-General Rafael Grossi stated that global nuclear power use could more than triple by 2060. This growth will be driven by electrification, AI data centres, and technology companies seeking reliable carbon-free power. In 2025, over 400 operating reactors across more than 30 countries produced 10 percent of global electricity. More than 60 new reactors are currently under construction and future nuclear capacity projections have shifted upward.

The Hindu: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY QUICK READ

Union Minister Dr Jitendra Singh inaugurates Worlds first- of -its-kind Air Pollution Analysis facility for Delhi NCR

Union Minister Dr Jitendra Singh inaugurated the Integrated Atmospheric Chemistry and Aerosol Toxicity Analysis Laboratory (AATAL) in Delhi-NCR. The facility was established at the Delhi branch of the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM) under Mission Mausam. AATAL is a first-of-its-kind global facility that identifies pollution sources in real time and assesses chemical composition and potential toxicity.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

India, Uzbekistan discuss bilateral ties during Jaishankar’s Azerbaijan visit

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar met Uzbek Foreign Minister Bakhtiyor Saidov in Baku, Azerbaijan, to discuss bilateral agenda issues. Both leaders emphasized the need for timely and effective implementation of high-level agreements reached between India and Uzbekistan. The meeting took place on the sidelines of Jaishankar's day-long visit to Azerbaijan to review bilateral ties and meet Azerbaijani leadership.

Economic Times: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE QUICK READ

Unesco team reviews conservation efforts in Hampi

A Unesco-ICOMOS reactive monitoring mission arrived in Hampi to inspect heritage monuments and review conservation measures until October 27. The visit aims to evaluate tourism infrastructure, future regulations, and development plans for the World Heritage site. The core issue involves balancing tourism growth, infrastructure development, and crowd management with the strict preservation requirements of a global heritage site.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

UP adds 14th Ramsar site, ranks second nationally in wetland recognition

Uttar Pradesh has added Sauj Jheel in Mainpuri as its 14th Ramsar site, raising the state total to 14 internationally recognised wetlands. The inclusion of Sauj Jheel on October 15 makes it the fourth wetland from Uttar Pradesh to receive Ramsar recognition in the year 2026. With this addition, Uttar Pradesh now holds the second-highest number of Ramsar sites in India, trailing only Tamil Nadu which has 20.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Zuqar Island

Yemen's Houthi rebels claimed they are trying to rescue a boat carrying 14 Indian nationals near Zuqar Island. The Houthi rebels alleged that the boat carrying Indian nationals was targeted by Saudi Arabia in the Red Sea. Zuqar Island is a Yemeni island situated in the southern Red Sea and forms part of the Hanish Islands archipelago.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION SCHEME REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

Allahabad High Court Declares Mandatory Injury Report Requirement Under UP Financial Assistance Scheme...

The matter came into the news following a court challenge and subsequent judgment concerning procedural conditions for state financial aid. The Allahabad High Court delivered a ruling regarding the mandatory requirement of an injury report under the Uttar Pradesh financial assistance scheme.

LiveLaw: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Saint Lucia and India Sign Agreement to Strengthen Medicine Quality and Access

The formal signing of the bilateral agreement between Saint Lucia and India put the partnership in the news. Saint Lucia and India signed an agreement to expand access to affordable medicines and enhance medical quality.

The Voice St. Lucia News: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES QUICK READ

New plant species in Arunachal named after CM Pema Khandu

Arunachal Pradesh Chief Minister Pema Khandu expressed deep concern over incidents of vandalism, arson, and looting in Pasighat during protests against the proposed 11,200-MW Siang Upper Multipurpose Project. The violence erupted on Friday night after a largely peaceful 12-hour bandh in Siang, Upper Siang, and East Siang districts, continuing until early Saturday morning.

ptinews.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

Global South lauds India's development assistance at 9th Annual India-UN Partnership Fund event

Permanent Representatives of partner nations praised New Delhi at the Ninth Annual India-UN Development Partnership Fund event. The event took place at the UNGA on October 22, drawing participation from nations including Laos, Sri Lanka, and Tanzania. Tuvalu's Permanent Representative highlighted the positive impact of Indian initiatives on grassroots education and local infrastructure. Saint Lucia's Permanent Representative emphasised the fund's pivotal role in empowering countries across the developing world.

msn.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

India's 18th BRICS Summit focuses on trade, technology and Global South cooperation

The event made news as India hosted the latest annual gathering of BRICS member nations. India hosted the 18th BRICS Summit, focusing its agenda on boosting trade, advancing technology sharing, and strengthening cooperation among countries of the Global South.

Sunday Independent: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Chhattisgarh: 3,500 wounded trees get 'bandages', grafts in Tiger reserve's Karka forest

More than 3,500 sal, bija and tendu trees in the Karka landscape of Udanti-Sitanadi Tiger Reserve have been found damaged by deliberate ring-barking. Girdling removes bark around the trunk and interrupts nutrient transport, causing trees to slowly die so encroached land can be opened up. Encroachment in the area expanded from 22 hectares in 2016 to 102.47 hectares in 2026, quadrupling in a decade.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME JUDGMENT QUICK READ

After the Supreme Court order, Railways extends travel insurance scheme for counter tickets

The Railway Board extended the optional travel insurance facility to passengers booking reserved tickets offline at railway counters following a Supreme Court order. The board directed all railway zones to implement the counter insurance facility by October 27, ensuring staff inform passengers about it. The core issue involves bridging the welfare gap for passengers from remote areas who rely on offline counters rather than online booking.

msn.com: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS3 The problem is inflation's second-round effects

Price pressures are likely to intensify globally and domestically. Global food prices are hardening, driven further by a strengthening El Nino. Rabi crops in India face potential negative impacts from El Nino. Energy prices remain elevated with Brent crude trading at around $115 per barrel. The central bank previously noted limited signs of supply-side pressures embedding in pricing behavior. Future policy tightening depends on committee assessments of supply-side pressures, growth-inflation dynamics, and second-round effects.

msn.com

GS2 Trump's Ukraine policy and the limits of strategic autonomy

Triggered by debates surrounding the future of US foreign policy under Donald Trump and its direct impact on the Ukraine conflict. An editorial discussing how Donald Trump's prospective Ukraine policy challenges the practical limits of strategic autonomy for nations.

Financial Express

GS2 Netanyahu's fate after the elections is unlikely to alter Israel's security policy

Israel's parliamentary election on October 27 will decide the fate of incumbent Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu in the first vote since the October 7, 2023 Hamas attack. The central question is whether leadership change will alter Israel's political trajectory or escalate the ongoing conflicts with Gaza and Iran. Opinion polls indicate neither the current coalition nor opposition parties will attain a majority, making the outcome dependent on shifting coalitions.

msn.com

GS3 COP17 puts Armenia's environmental record in the spotlight

Armenia is hosting the COP17 biodiversity conference despite ranking poorly on waste management at 164th and wastewater treatment at 165th. The author argues that Armenia has failed to use the hosting opportunity to address its longstanding and serious environmental challenges. Armenia's economy heavily relies on mining, including the Zangezur, Agarak, and Teghut copper-molybdenum mines using open-pit methods. The World Bank identifies mining as a major pollution source, and the Artsvanik tailings reservoir is linked to heavy-metal waterway contamination.

Al Jazeera

GS2 Odisha CM: From Congress, selective outrage — and deep hypocrisy

Opposition parties held demonstrations in Delhi seeking the Chief Election Commissioner's resignation without any adverse judicial findings from the Supreme Court. Protests erupted over the Special Summary Revision (SIR) process, but the author argues the opposition only challenges outcomes where it loses elections. The core issue is whether current political outrage reflects genuine institutional defense or political opportunism given historical executive interference in election oversight.

msn.com

GS1 Cities united by a literary soul

The shared distinction of Barcelona, Dublin, and Kozhikode as UNESCO Cities of Literature brought them into focus. An editorial highlighting the global cultural connection between Barcelona, Dublin, and Kozhikode as holders of the UNESCO City of Literature title. Barcelona, Dublin, and Kozhikode proudly bear the title of UNESCO City of Literature

The Hindu

GS1 GS2 Accept agency, fight coercion

The Supreme Court directed magistrates to conduct a mandatory threshold inquiry during anti-trafficking operations to distinguish between voluntary sex work and human trafficking. This directive seeks to return agency to adult women by inquiring whether they consented to sex work, pushing the State to consider their fundamental right to life and livelihood. Traditional anti-trafficking raids assume all sex workers are victims of exploitation, leading to detention in care homes, forced medical check-ups, and repatriation.

Hindustan Times

GS1 HP Nanda: A master of the old economy whose successors inherited a different world

The article evaluates the journey of traditional Indian business leaders and their successors in a changing economic world. An opinion piece reflecting on the legacy of industrialist HP Nanda and how his successors inherited a transformed economic landscape. In post-Partition India, Nanda built an engineering and automotive group spanning tractors, farm machinery, motorcycles and construction equipment.

Mint

GS2 When you blame ‘foreign hand’ for SIR protests, you’re hurting India’s diplomatic capital

The ongoing protests in Delhi over the SIR crisis and the electoral roll have raised international diplomatic interest and led to embassy briefings. Questions regarding the centralisation of electoral-roll data and voter flagging in ECINet software threaten India's global tech and electoral assistance exports. India's foreign policy community fears that recent government collapses in Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, and Nepal reflect external trial runs targeting India.

ThePrint

GS3 It's time Delhi set the pace in scaling up businesses

India has successfully moved from apprehension around doing business to ensuring greater ease of doing business. The next economic phase must focus heavily on the ease of scaling businesses for international competitiveness. Delhi as the national capital possesses a vibrant economic ecosystem integrating finance, technology, start-ups, and markets. Entrepreneurs require predictable regulations, efficient approvals, dependable infrastructure, and smooth access to finance and workers. Emerging urban hubs like Dwarka can support fresh investments across technology, logistics, healthcare, and education.

Economic Times

GS2 China’s panda diplomacy wanes

Chinese President Xi Jinping announced the dispatch of a breeding pair of giant pandas, Ping Ping and Fu Shuang, to Zoo Atlanta during his recent visit to Washington. China uses panda diplomacy as soft power to project a charming image, while leveraging lucrative commercial rentals and strict political conditions. The author argues that panda diplomacy embodies manipulation and exploitation, masking China's appropriation of Tibetan geography and wildlife resources.

tribuneindia.com

GS2 GS3 AI is neither poison nor panacea for doctors

Both doctors and patients increasingly consult artificial intelligence tools independently, often unaware of each other's use of the same technology. A 2026 study in Nature tested an autonomous system named MIRA, showing a diagnostic accuracy of 87.8% compared to 78.1% among physicians. The primary debate centers on how much care autonomous AI should be permitted to perform and who bears responsibility when harm occurs. A 2025 US FDA clearance was given to UpDoc, which provides insulin-dose instructions for type-2 diabetes under clinician-set targets and limits.

Hindustan Times

GS2 Washington, Moscow, and the moral hazard of withheld munitions

Renewed backchannel diplomacy between Washington and Moscow to explore an armistice has sparked an acute crisis of confidence within the western coalition. The interceptor dilemma involves the visible throttling of critical Patriot air-defence missile shipments from the US to Kyiv. American policymakers frame the slowdown as a logistical necessity due to depleted global stockpiles and a need to deter conflicts in other theatres. Kyiv views the withheld defensive munitions not as a peace incentive, but as a coercive strategy that strips away its civilian shelter.

Hindustan Times

GS1 GS3 On a changing planet

The persistent escalation of severe weather impacts and urban vulnerabilities has brought disaster management back into public focus. The editorial discusses how climate change, rapid urban development, and poor disaster preparedness combine to turn natural hazards into major catastrophes. Climate change, urban development, and lack of disaster preparedness are making natural hazards turn into catastrophic events

The Hindu

GS3 Surjit Bhalla: SIR needs reform. But let's go by numbers, not protestors' slogans

It was published in the Indian Express as an opinion piece by Surjit Bhalla addressing the debate around reform and public protests. An editorial discussing how policy reforms should be guided by empirical data and statistical evidence rather than emotional protests.

Indian Express

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Why have new enumerators been introduced for Census 2027? A recent Home Ministry notification regarding new enumerator rules triggered political controversy and allegations. The Home Ministry notified a sudden change regarding who can serve as an enumerator for Census 2027.

Frontline

New Census rules include private teachers as enumerators. Can they be forced to do the job? The rules were updated to include private teachers to overcome staff shortages during the census process. New Census rules empower the government to appoint private school teachers as census enumerators, raising questions on legal obligations.

Indian Express

Census 2027: Can private teachers or citizens be forced to do Census duty? The upcoming Census 2027 has put the rules regarding census enumeration staffing and legal obligations in the news. This explainer examines the legal provisions governing who can be appointed as a census officer and whether private individuals or teachers can be forced to perform census duties.

Indian Express

Knowledge Nugget | How is India's statistics ministry rethinking its Periodic Labour Force Survey? The initiative is in the news due to ongoing efforts by the statistics ministry to modernise India's labour market measurement tools. The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation is reviewing and rethinking the Periodic Labour Force Survey to better capture modern employment trends.

Indian Express

How ISRO's new satellite could restore India's regional GPS alternative The mission was highlighted as a crucial step to replace aging satellites and restore the full operational capability of India's regional GPS alternative. ISRO is set to launch a new satellite to restore and strengthen India's regional satellite navigation system, NavIC.

Indian Express

Obesity in India – Reasons & Impacts Childhood and adult obesity are rising sharply in India due to increased consumption of high-fat foods, sugars, and sedentary lifestyles. According to the World Obesity Atlas, India ranks second globally with over 40 million overweight or obese children.

ForumIAS

'Godzilla' El Nino: How extreme warming could hit India and the world It is in the news due to growing scientific concerns over extreme weather anomalies and their severe socioeconomic impacts. An explainer on the Godzilla El Nino phenomenon, detailing how extreme ocean warming affects weather systems globally.

Indian Express

How is Kerala planning to prevent child deaths linked to malnutrition and neglect? Explained The initiative is in the news due to the state government's new proactive policy measures aimed at stopping child deaths caused by malnutrition and neglect. Kerala is launching a State-wide vulnerability mapping initiative to identify children living in conditions that risk their health, education, and safety, followed by regular monitoring to prevent malnutrition and neglect.

The Hindu

India-China LAC face-off: Understanding the border tensions in Arunachal Pradesh The ongoing sensitivity surrounding India-China border management keeps the LAC face-offs relevant for public and strategic discourse. This explainer details the border tensions and strategic friction between India and China along the Line of Actual Control in Arunachal Pradesh.

Indian Express

Indian Overseas Bank privatisation: What is the buzz about? Centre's rules and regulations for the process, explained The government is considering reducing its stake in four public sector banks to 75% to comply with minimum public shareholding norms. The four banks are Central Bank of India, UCO Bank, Punjab & Sind Bank, and Indian Overseas Bank.

msn.com

Can India move from being the world's biggest Basmati rice exporter to its most trusted? The necessity to evaluate the quality, standards, and global trust associated with Indian Basmati rice exports. An analysis of how India can transform its position as the top global exporter of Basmati rice into a trusted and premium national brand.

BusinessLine

Black triangles spotted over US military bases: What are these mysterious triangular objects? Newly declassified government documents revealed that mysterious black triangle-shaped objects were spotted moving over classified US military installations. These sightings occurred on at least three different occasions throughout the past year near sensitive government facilities. The objects moved at speeds up to 1,800 miles per hour without leaving vapor trails.
hindustantimes.com

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- India-Germany R&D partnership can boost joint innovation, manufacturing: Piyush Goyal (International Relations) BusinessLine
- Island of Mindanao, Location, Geography, Rivers, Mountains (Geography) Vajiram & Ravi
- Two-Day State-Level ‘Shram Samvad’ Programme on Labour Codes, Labour Welfare and Social Protection to begin in Lucknow on 26th October (Governance & Policy) PIB
- Digital India BHASHINI Division Showcases Multilingual AI Solutions for Accessible Research at ETD-2026, IIT Delhi (Governance & Policy) PIB
- Parliamentary Committee on Finance to examine 46 economic issues, including crypto, AI, in FY'27 (Polity & Constitution) BusinessLine
- Agricultural Biological Resources generate around Rs. 1.04 Crore in ABS Benefits for Biodiversity Initiatives across India (Environment & Ecology) PIB
- This isn’t the UN we need (International Relations) ForumIAS
- Legislative Councils in India: Powers, Elections and Role (Polity & Constitution) Vajiram & Ravi
- India's emerging sectors to drive capex, credit demand towards storage, semiconductors: Report (Economy) BusinessLine
- India-China Border Tensions: LAC, ITBP and Border Management (Internal Security) Vajiram & Ravi
- Odisha Cyclone Alert 2026, Date, Name, Latest Update, Tracker (Disaster Management) Vajiram & Ravi
- Ukraine joins NATO's NSPA partnership, gains access to Alliance contracts for defence industry (International Relations) Economic Times
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- Road Ministry seeks forensic audit of its portals after vehicle data leak (Governance & Policy) The Hindu
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- SBI Data Breach: State Bank of India Customers Have No DPDP Act Remedy (Economy) The Probe
- Uttar Pradesh Tops Mission Karmayogi Implementation (Governance & Policy) GKToday
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- Denmark expects COP31 in Türkiye to deliver concrete climate action (Environment & Ecology) Anadolu Ajans
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- Tamil Nadu Semiconductor and Advanced Electronics Policy 2024: Building a High-Value Electronics Ecosystem (Economy) IMPRI Impact and Policy Research Institute
- Supreme Court Quashes High Court Order on IFS Promotions — Upholds Regulatory Compliance. The High Court's direction for adjustment of officers was found to be unsustainable as it exceeded jurisdiction without challenging the review committee's recom (Polity & Constitution) Lawtext
- Kashmir’s aromatic Rice, Mushk Budji showcased during Bharat International Rice Conference (Agriculture & Allied) jknewstoday.com

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- NavIC-3 launch on October 30: Smartphones to get precise location, phone production costs to fall (Science & Technology) Kerala Kaumudi
- Advanced Emergency Braking System (AEBS) (Governance & Policy) Vajiram & Ravi
- Mumbai Rapido Driver Arrested For Suspected Jaish Links, Remarks Against PM (Internal Security) NDTV

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 21 must-know, 30 Prelims facts, 45 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Environment & Ecology (10), Economy (8), Polity & Constitution (7), International Relations (7), Governance & Policy (5), Agriculture & Allied (4), Defence (3), Science & Technology (2), Infrastructure & Energy (2), History, Art & Culture (2), Social Justice & Welfare (1). **Nothing today in —** Health, Education, Internal Security, Disaster Management, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 1 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 2 · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: nothing today · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: nothing today

Full text — 48 of 78 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 9, PIB 7, msn.com 7, Indian Express 7, Hindustan Times 6, Vajiram & Ravi 4, ForumIAS 3, Economic Times 3, timesofindia.indiatimes.com 3, Mint 2, IMPRI Impact and Policy Research Institute 1, OpenGov Asia 1, The Indian Express 1, Lawtext 1

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